

Human Informed Consent Form

Instructions to the Student Researcher(s): An informed consent/assent/permission form should be developed in consultation with the Adult Sponsor, Direct Supervisor or Qualified Scientist.

This form is used to provide information to the research participant (or parent/guardian) and to document written informed consent, minor assent, and/or parental permission.

- When written documentation is required, the researcher keeps the original, signed form.
- Students may use this sample form or may copy ALL elements of it into a new document.

If the form is serving to document parental permission, a copy of any survey or questionnaire must be attached.

Student Researcher(s): Jacob Michael, Niel Peddibhotla

Title of Project: Examining the Impact of Manic-Like Defendant Behavior on Juror Perception and Decision-Making in Simulated Trials

I am asking for your voluntary participation in my science fair project. Please read the following information about the project. If you would like to participate, please sign in the appropriate area below.

Purpose of the project:

The purpose of this study is to examine how jurors perceive defendants who display different observable behavioral styles during courtroom testimony. Specifically, the study explores whether manic-like behaviors (such as rapid speech, distractibility, or emotional intensity) influence juror judgments of credibility, responsibility, and punishment severity in simulated trial scenarios. This research aims to better understand how behavioral misinterpretation may contribute to bias in legal decision-making.

If you participate, you will be asked to:

If you choose to participate, you will watch a short, pre-recorded mock courtroom video and then complete an online questionnaire evaluating the defendant's behavior, credibility, and appropriate legal consequences. No personal or identifying information will be requested at any point during the study.

Time required for participation:

Approximately 10-15 minutes total

Potential Risks of Study:

This study involves minimal risk. Some participants may experience mild or brief discomfort when observing emotionally elevated or atypical behavior. No graphic, violent, or distressing content is included. You may stop participating at any time without penalty.

Benefits:

There is no direct benefit to participants. However, this research may help increase understanding of juror bias and contribute to improved fairness in legal decision-making.

How confidentiality will be maintained:

All data will be collected anonymously. No names, email addresses, or other identifying information will be collected or linked to participant responses. Data will be recorded using numeric identifiers only and will be used solely for research analysis and reporting purposes. Access to the data will be limited to the student researcher and supervising adult, and all data will be securely stored and deleted following completion of the project.

If you have any questions about this study, feel free to contact: jsmichael365@gmail.com

Adult Sponsor/QS/DS: Robert McAuliffe Phone/email: rmcauliffe@wcpss.net

Voluntary Participation:

Participation in this study is completely voluntary. If you decide not to participate there will not be negative consequences. Please be aware that if you decide to participate, you may stop participating at any time and you may decide not to answer any specific question.

By signing this form I am attesting that I have read and understand the information above and I freely give my consent/assent to participate or permission for my child to participate.

Adult Informed Consent or Minor Assent

Date Reviewed & Signed: _____
(mm/dd/yy)

Research Participant Printed Name: _____

Signature: _____

Parental/Guardian Permission (if applicable)

Date Reviewed & Signed: _____
(mm/dd/yy)

Parent/Guardian Printed Name: _____

Signature: _____